

the problems, not treat the symptoms.

For instance, if a young couple spends more than they make, quite often they will ask their parents for help. The plea is, "We try, but we just can't make ends meet. We can't stand the pressure." No parent wants their child to be under that kind of pressure. So with the best of intentions, they give or lend the kids money. Does that solve the problem? No. It treats the symptom. The problem will surface again elsewhere.

Until husbands and wives learn to manage the money they already have, more money will not help. God's Word teaches elementary principles of self-discipline. Most young couples have been taught to think the world's way. Now you must condition yourself to think God's way. Manage what you have well before looking for more.

8 CORRECTING THE PROBLEMS

The real problems surrounding finances are usually related to one of three basic areas: ignorance, greed, and communications. Let's look at the first problem: ignorance.

IGNORANCE

Ignorance is not stupidity. Ignorance is a lack of understanding. For example, I received a call one afternoon from a young man I'll call Lee who sounded very desperate. He said, "I have an urgent problem. My wife, Melody, has been arrested for writing a bad check, and they put her in jail. Can you help us?"

The first thing we did was arrange for someone to go to the jail and bail her out. When they both came in for counseling the next day, I asked Melody, "Why did you write a bad check? Did you do it purposely?"

"No," she said. "I don't understand it. I was sure I had enough money in my account to pay all of my bills."

It turned out that this was the *third* time Melody had written the same merchant a bad check. That's why she was arrested.